

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

WILLIAMS BAPTIST UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: April 15-16, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an on-site review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

WILLIAMS BAPTIST UNIVERSITY

TRADITIONAL

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	APPROACHING

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

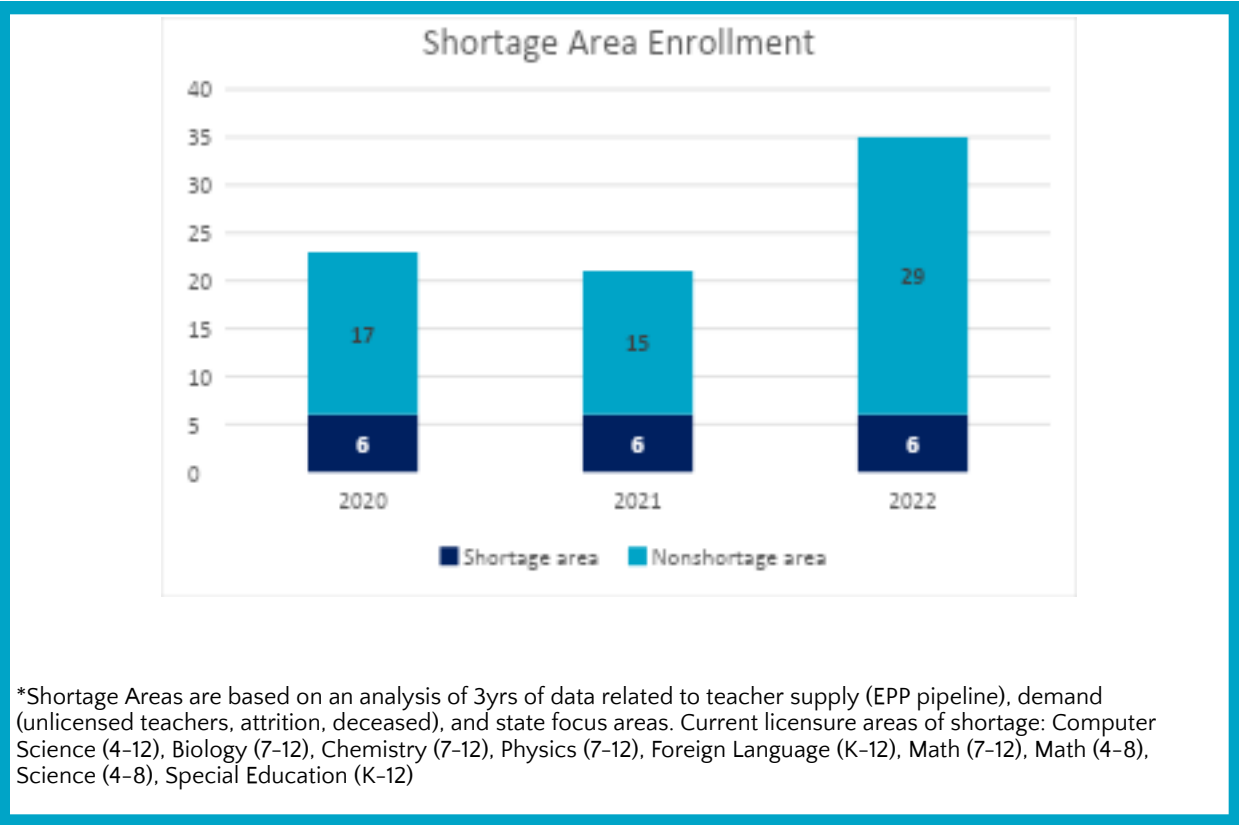
Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	MEETS	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
- Begin preparing to submit a formal plan in October that addresses all Indicators in the State Review Framework and provides evidence of action towards continuous improvement. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 1.1a</i>) - Recruiting additional candidates in subject shortage areas will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 1.2b</i>)		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	EPPs were not asked to submit formal plans to meet the state review framework targets or to show evidence of acting on their plans as part of the Spring 2024 review cycle. As a result, all EPPs in this cycle will receive a rating of MEETS.

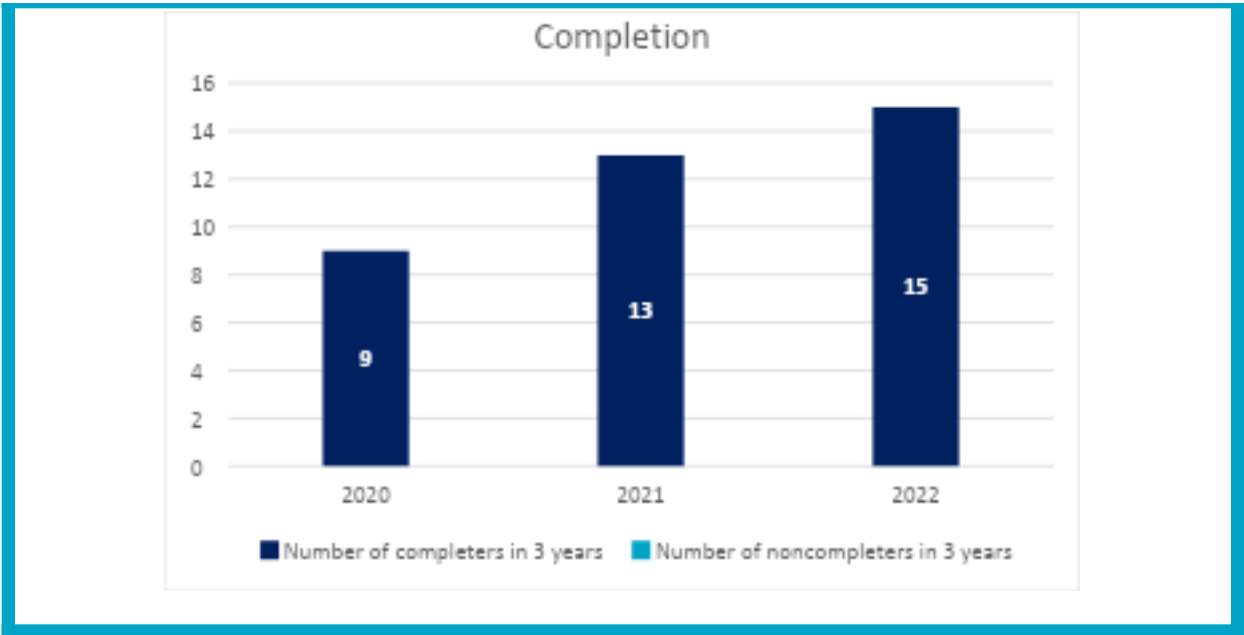
INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs																	
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level														
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	81.1%	EXCEEDS														
Metric is the percentage growth between blue and green boxes. <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Percentage Growth</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2017</td><td>9</td></tr><tr><td>2018</td><td>13</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>15</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>19</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>18</td></tr><tr><td>2022</td><td>30</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Percentage Growth	2017	9	2018	13	2019	15	2020	19	2021	18	2022	30
Year	Percentage Growth																
2017	9																
2018	13																
2019	15																
2020	19																
2021	18																
2022	30																
*The enrollment growth target was established to close the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a "Meets" rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an "Exceeds" rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.																	
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need																	
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of new enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level														
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	23%	MEETS														



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	100%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
The Williams Teacher Education Program (WTEP) at Williams Baptist University has a particularly strong clinical experience program. The coursework is aligned, and teaching candidates have opportunities to utilize HQIM. The teaching candidates also have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisors and course instructors. The WTEP already has a planned timeline to ensure that all WTEP supervisors have completed coaching training before supervising an intern, as required by recent changes to requirements plans. The WTEP is well regarded by partner schools, and collaborative processes are in place with districts and schools to co-construct clinical experiences. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • By 2024–25, EPPs will need to show evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use. Training and norming on the rubric should be completed for clinical supervisors to ensure use for the Fall 2024. • By 2026–2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. • Williams Baptist University should continue planning to meet the state’s one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
MEETS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction
MEETS
Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction, including recognizing and using high-quality instructional materials and evidence-based practices. Reviewers saw evidence that teaching candidates in EPP, the Williams Teacher Education Program (WTEP), use and reflect on HQIM in their coursework. In Math for Teachers II (MT 4123), candidates in K–6 and Middle-Level Programs were provided accounts for online use of the iReady Math Curriculum. Candidates utilized iReady to plan and implement a lesson aligned with an Arkansas 8th grade Math Standard. Reviewers also saw evidence of activities utilizing the EdReports website, which designates iReady as an HQIM. In the Coursework focus group, reviewers noted that candidates were familiar with multiple HQIMs utilized in the schools and districts where they serve, such as i-Ready, Heggerty, Wit and Wisdom, and CKLA. One participant gave

the example of seeing Heggerty modeled in the schools and then engaging with the curriculum in coursework. She said the course participants would practice teaching the lessons to their peers.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants mentioned how the WTEP partnered with their Coop to survey districts about their usage of HQIM and then secured access to CKLA and iReady for all candidates to use throughout their coursework. This was also documented in the evidence provided.

Reviewers saw evidence of candidates engaging with HQIM and using other evidence-based practices in two-course observations. In MT 4123, the teaching candidates participated in a book study, discussed what they could implement in the classroom, and practiced an engagement model of having the students work at the whiteboard. While the Course Instructor modeled a lesson, she made connections to iReady (HQIM). In Reading Instruction K-6 (ED 3233), the content instructor referenced RISE, and sound walls were posted around the room. Students were asked to link their focus standard in their lesson and ensure that the strategies aligned with the standard.

The state's Science of Reading requirement is met at the awareness level throughout licensure areas with approved programs (ED 4603, IDEAS portal). In Fall ED 3112, WBU plans to offer a new awareness course which will be offered for Middle-Level, Secondary, and K-12 Candidates. The program revision still needs to be submitted and approved by DESE.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K-12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

MEETS

Reviewers saw multiple examples of teaching candidates working with AR State Standards across grade bands and standards. They submitted sample lesson plans that included the standard with an aligned curriculum for instruction. In Clinical Internship I (ED 4526), candidates conduct an "Impact on Student Learning Research Project" in which they create three learning goals aligned with AR State Standards. They pre-assess their learners, teach three to five lessons aligned to their chosen goals, and post-assess their learning. In Measurement & Evaluation (ED 4133), the Course instructor models unpacking a standard. The lesson plan rubric shows a clear emphasis on standard alignment and scaffolding.

Reviewers saw evidence of the standards in course observations. In ED 4133, teaching candidates examined multiple examples of K-12 Standards throughout different grade bands as a whole class, in pairs, and then independently. In MT 4123, the course instructor intentionally familiarizes candidates with the standard language and structure. For example, she asked the candidates to "Look up Standard 7.PR.1" (the grade, section, and first concept). Reviewers saw evidence of the course instructor providing candidates opportunities to integrate standards vertically. They compared "constant and proportionality" in grades seven and eight.

One candidate in the Coursework focus group stated, "Even as Middle Level, I would say that I'm prepared to teach other content areas." Several other participants nodded in agreement. Another participant said, "In ELA, we are required to have a standard for every lesson we teach; we use a backward design cycle, look at standards, then assessment, then figure out how to teach it to fill in the gap."

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants said that candidates are exposed to all grade bands within the licensure area by assigning different grade level standards to different groups of candidates who demonstrate lessons to their peers. Candidates have opportunities to vertically integrate standards in multiple courses, including with the Coop science specialist in "Science for Teachers" to create 5E lessons using the new science standards. Another example is how procedural fluency develops from grade to grade in MT 4123, and in ED 4183, students evaluate the vertical alignment of standards within various HQIMs.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework, providing candidates an opportunity to show proficiency. This includes reinforcement opportunities for candidate growth areas and shows a progressive increase in rigor. Documents submitted as evidence include the "Traditional Program Progression Points," which show the traditional program milestones from Education Major to WTEP Completer, including related Praxis exam assessments. The "Traditional Program Degree Plans" include the degree plans for all eight traditional programs. The degree plans show the progression of coursework from "General Education Requirements" to "Pre-Professional," "Specialization," "Professional," and "Clinical Internship." In the "2023-24 Introduction to Teaching Handbook," page 11 explains how courses are designed to become more rigorous as the numbering system increases and emphasizes the importance of consulting with the teaching candidate's assigned academic advisor.

The Clinical Experience focus group provided examples from multiple candidates (and many agreement nods or thumbs up) to illustrate that coursework progression supports their development as a teacher. Some examples that candidates mentioned included "Strategy City" (a document with several classroom teaching strategies used as a reference for clinical experiences), teaching practice lessons to peers (at least once a week), Diverse Learners project in Newport (teaching candidates prepare their lessons in class, teach in the schools and get feedback from both the course instructor and teacher from Newport).

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area. All licensure area matrices show clear alignment to competencies and teaching standards.

The "Traditional Program Matrix of Alignment of AR Educator Competencies in all Content Areas" document shows how every WTEP Undergraduate degree is aligned with the DESE Content Area Educator Competencies. The Matrices demonstrate intentionality. The "Traditional Program Course Alignment with Arkansas Teaching Standards" shows evidence of all licensure areas that indicate which Standards are targeted in each course. All of the ATS are addressed in multiple courses. Every traditional candidate takes all of the courses listed in the matrix. Evidence is also seen in each syllabus that indicates an ATS focus.

In the "Survey of the Influence of Impact on Student Learning Project," survey data was provided showing teacher candidates rating their Student Learning Project as "Highly Effective" or "Effective" in preparing them to apply ATS "almost all the time."

Reviewers saw explicit evidence of this in two courses observed. In Integrated Methods (ED 4183), the course instructor asked teaching candidates to identify which TESS domains address the classroom environment, list the two to three procedures that they will incorporate into their lesson when they teach it next week, and discuss the importance and rationale behind the TESS domain and procedures. In Math for Teachers II (MT 4123), the course instructors asked the teaching candidates which TESS domain would align with the focus of their lesson on student engagement. They discussed Domains 2 and 3.

In the Coursework focus group, several examples from multiple candidates (and many agreement nods or thumbs up) were provided to support this rating, including: The Diverse Learners Project rubric shows how each component is aligned with AR and InTASC standards, tagging each lesson with the standards. Candidates have five different options for professional development to improve in particular AR Standard areas. The "Disposition Reflection" has six components necessary for applying to the WTEP, and each area is linked to the Arkansas Teaching Standards.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

EXCEEDS

The mission of the Williams Teacher Education Program (WTEP) is to prepare professional educators who are intentional, reflective, and growing in their teaching practice. Reviewers saw evidence that coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience. Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the

alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. WTEP submitted a document, "Alignment of Coursework to Clinical Experiences at each Progression Point in the WTEP" that charts the alignment with coursework and clinical experiences throughout each progression point in the WTEP. Multiple pieces of evidence were submitted to show the cadence of clinical experiences and the reflection assignments afterward such as the "Candidate Video Reflection Example" and "PreClinical Reflection After Diverse Learner Field Experience."

Reviewers saw evidence of this in the courses observed. In "Integrated Methods," teaching candidates are preparing to teach a lesson at a partner school on the following Monday and deciding on procedures to include in their lesson plan appropriate for their grade level. The entire lesson was discussion and preparing lessons for their clinical experience. In the Coursework focus group, candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. Several examples were provided by candidates to support this rating: In clinical experience courses, candidates were given a variety of ways to evaluate the teacher they were observing; if lesson objectives were posted in the room, if they witnessed teacher respect and rapport (was it teacher-student or student-student), looking at pedagogical strategies, looking at a classroom in various ways; evaluating themselves as teachers. One candidate recognized Heggerty (used in her Emergent Literacy course) while in her Field 1 course in the classroom (grades K-3). Another mentioned that they did not see Heggerty but did see CKLA, and they also mentioned going to the Coop to dig into standards.

The document, "WTEP Undergraduate and Graduate Review of Data," demonstrates that the WTEP maintains a system for annual evaluation and continuous improvement to align coursework with clinical experience.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K12 Standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. Evidence shows most of the course instructors have K-12 teaching experience and are licensed, are TESS trained and have attended recent professional development and conferences intentionally aligned with the courses they are teaching, such as Cognitive Coaching, HQIM communities of Practice, National Science Teachers Conference, CKLA, RISE, and NEA Math development.

In the Program Director focus group, the Director shared that during the interview process, instructors model a lesson in front of the faculty to show they can demonstrate criteria for a specific position and model dispositions, have experience coaching, mentoring, and giving feedback. All instructors must have classroom experience and a teaching certificate.

In the Course Instructor group, participants said they had completed numerous trainings, including Kagan, Ron Clark, National Science Teacher Association conference, Cognitive Coaching, RISE, LETRs, Capturing Kids Hearts, Solution Tree, TNTP, coop workshops, and book studies. Each instructor is formally evaluated annually, and WBU provides a faculty development fund to support instructors with development specific to their identified needs.

Reviewers also cited evidence of this in the course observations they saw, and teaching candidates in the Coursework focus group all agreed that they felt their course instructors were very knowledgeable.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

MEETS

During the on-site review, reviewers saw evidence of strong facilitation of most course instructors. They also noted evidence of providing feedback and support. For example, in the Integrated Methods and Classroom Management (ED 4183) course, the teaching candidates participated in Understanding By Design (UBD) planning. Their lesson plan was linked to AR K-12 Standards, and feedback was incorporated from the course instructor. Multiple examples were provided throughout the on-site review of course instructor comments and feedback. Feedback is provided in Google Docs comments so candidates can reply to the comments and note the incorporated feedback. The feedback is also useful because teaching candidates may use the comments as evidence in their portfolio project that spans their time in the WTEB. Another example is the "Candidate Planning for Learning Differences" project in the Study of the School Field Experience Diverse Learner Project (ED 4113). The course instructor showed evidence of strong facilitation of coursework by leading students through a gradual release model, demonstrating and normalizing multiple approaches to unpacking standards, and providing individualized feedback on candidate's work.

In one course observation, “Integrated Methods and Classroom Management (ED 4183), the course instructor provided feedback and during the observation had peers give feedback using the same rubric, using sticky notes to add thoughts and give a different perspective on what procedures to include for specific grade levels; the course instructor models many strategies for the classroom including an introductory culture builder and teacher candidates are doing most of the thinking by working on a lesson plan aligned to their clinical experience. In Math for Teachers II (MT 4123), the course instructor showed evidence of strong facilitation of coursework with student engagement by demonstrating a “fishbowl” structure to have students explain and discuss each other’s work. In Reading Instruction K-6 (ED 3233), the course instructor provided feedback and support in Google Classroom before the lesson. Teaching candidates were paired up to continue working on lesson creation and aligning the “Big Rock” standard.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

EXCEEDS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

EXCEEDS

The overall sequence of clinical experiences in the WTEP clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. Traditional route candidates complete two 8-week internships. The Clinical Internship Handbook outlines a suggested timeline that includes pre-clinical experience (observing cooperating teachers) and clinical experience. During the clinical experience, there are three stages: observation and orientation, moving from limited to extensive teaching experience, and full teaching responsibility. Through the Diverse Learner Project, teacher candidates plan and teach a read-aloud lesson and extension activity in Newport School District. After the lesson, teacher candidates reflect on their growth in specific TESS components. The “Progression of Clinical Experiences in the WTEP” document charts the alignment of coursework to clinical experiences. It lists all the courses, the durations, and details of the clinical experiences. It also details examples, assignments, rubrics, and observation forms for the different experiences.

Evidence was submitted showing candidate reflection after a teaching assignment. WTEB included assignments, a work sample of reflection documents, and a video reflecting on goal setting for growth, feedback, and development in specific components of TESS. In the Clinical Experience focus group, all seven participants agreed that in the traditional pathway, there was a gradual release of duties and responsibilities in the classrooms throughout their progression of clinical experiences.

The “Document Measured in the WTEP Undergraduate and Graduate Review of Data” demonstrates that the WTEP maintains a system for annual evaluation and continuous improvement for how all clinical experiences are sequenced for candidates.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

EXCEEDS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. The “2023–2024 Introduction to Teaching Handbook” was submitted with documents as evidence for this metric. In the Handbook, it says at least two field experiences must be conducted in partnership schools that are above the state average in categories including “Disability (special education)” and “Limited English Proficient (LEP).” On page 28, it describes the requirement of placements for observations and field experiences in schools with varied learning needs (language delay, attention problems, developmental delays and learning disabilities, emotional/social problems, impaired vision and hearing, etc.). The WTEB also tracks and collects data to ensure candidates have a variety of placements. For example, the “Percentage of Clinical Experiences in Diverse Settings by Program” spreadsheet illustrates each program and the variety of clinical experiences the teaching candidates have had. It shows that each year from 2020, the percentage of access to a variety of clinical experiences has increased. The “ED 3012 Field Placements Fall 21–Fall 23” spreadsheet shows the placements for the interns (teaching candidates). Candidates are placed in two Kindergarten, two 1st or 2nd grade, and two 3rd grade placements to observe multiple grades of early literacy instruction. The “Internship Placement Tracking Document” is a spreadsheet to help ensure all candidates have two placements for internship– one in their lower-grade band and one in their upper-grade band. The document shows evidence over the past five years.

The evidence stated above was corroborated in the Clinical Experiences focus group. Participants mentioned that each candidate had experience in different schools. While teaching lessons, they planned for all types of learners in each lesson. Their peers would sit in on those lessons and provide feedback. One participant shared that their internship included a science inclusion class. Due to the number of students with IEPs, it was difficult; however, they understood it was part of the experience of being a teacher and worked through it.

The “Document Measured in the WTEP Undergraduate and Graduate Review of Data” demonstrates that the WTEP maintains a system for annual evaluation and continuous improvement for how all clinical experiences are selected and structured for candidates.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship MEETS

Metric 1: The Effectiveness of Experienced Mentor Teachers MEETS

Evidence shows that most experienced mentor teachers (cooperating teachers) are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development properly. The “Cooperating Teacher Qualification Data” lists the mentor teachers and their qualifications. Most of them have multiple years of experience and TESS training.

At the end of each placement, teacher candidates (interns) evaluate their experienced mentor teachers. In Fall 2023, 89% of interns said they would recommend their EMT for a future intern,” and in Spring 2023, 93% said they would recommend them.

Note: By 2026–2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers MEETS

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers based on a set of criteria. The Google form, “K-12 Cooperating Teacher Qualification Data”, shows cooperating teacher (experienced mentor teacher) qualifications for interns in all programs for four semesters: Degrees and Certifications held, 100% had at least three years teaching experience, most were TESS trained, 100% completed appropriate SOR training. The WTEB also ensures all cooperating teachers hold a standard AR teaching license and have completed the SOR pathway for their grade levels. The “MOU with Jonesboro School District” document provides evidence to support the criteria of becoming a cooperating teacher (experienced mentor teacher). Emails were also submitted as evidence listing criteria for cooperating teachers. The “WTEP Partnership Schools List with Contacts” lists the partnership contact information at each school of who collaborates with school placements. There are over 20 districts on the spreadsheet. Teaching candidates complete a “Reflection of Pre-Clinical Experience” assignment which involves the teaching candidate in the process of matching an experienced mentor teacher to each intern. Each candidate completes a reflection of their experience at the pre-clinical visit, including questions to determine if the placement is a good fit for the intern and the cooperating teacher. The Department Chair reviews the reflections and collaborates to make the final determination about placements.

The Program Director focus group participants also mentioned the process outlined in the Handbook. In the Experienced Mentor teacher focus group, the participants did not mention a formal process; however, they knew they met the qualifications and said they were passionate about helping candidates become good teachers.

Note: By 2026–2027, evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have a minimum 3 years of teaching experience, hold a standard Arkansas educator license with a Lead or Master Professional Educator designation, and have evidence of an annual rating of effective or higher in DESE's Educator Effectiveness System must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. Evidence submitted included the “WTEP End of Program” data, which showed for Spring 2023 completers that

100% of the 14 candidates who completed the survey rated effective or highly effective as WTEP supervisors. 100% of the 5 candidates who completed the survey in Fall 2023 rated their WTEP supervisor as “Effective” or “Highly Effective”.

Documents also included the “Faculty & Intern Supervisor Qualifications,” which showed that two full-time Education Faculty and four adjunct supervisors in the traditional program hold degrees in education, and all but one have multiple years of experience teaching in K-12 Education in Arkansas schools. Six out of eight are TESS trained.

Out of a list of helpful resources in the “Cooperating Teacher Feedback Survey,” 69% of mentor teachers chose the internship supervisor visits as the most beneficial resource. 51.7% chose the TESS consensus scoring meeting and collaboration as the most beneficial resource.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

APPROACHING

Candidates consistently receive weekly feedback from their clinical supervisor, both written and oral, connected to the TESS rubric. Some of the Clinical Experience observations were linked to evidence of student learning. Some feedback builds on previous feedback; however, reviewers stated that the quality of the feedback varied across the four Clinical Experience observations.

In one observation, the clinical supervisor showed some evidence of effective instructional practices by focusing on the intern’s DOK (Depth of Knowledge) questioning and discussing how to improve student participation, however, the goal setting was general. In the second observation, the clinical supervisor allowed the intern to reflect and prepare for their coaching conversation. The clinical supervisor paraphrased, asked questions, and offered support and feedback to inform the intern’s goals. In the third observation, the clinical supervisor focused on the teacher’s growth, lesson planning and setting specific goals and strategies for the next lesson.

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place to co-construct the clinical experience. Each partner school or district signs an MOU with Williams Baptist. The WTEP has over 20 MOUs in place. In a survey given to mentor teachers, most agreed that having an intern in their classroom was beneficial to them and their students, and many complimented the program, support, and communication.

In addition to internship partnerships, Williams Baptist has created the Diverse Learners Project in partnership with Newport School District to offer an opportunity for teacher candidates to plan a read-aloud lesson and receive feedback from the Newport teachers.

Surveys were compiled from 58 cooperating teachers (mentors) regarding their experience of hosting a WTEB intern. Cooperating Teachers (mentor teachers) either “strongly agree” (55.2%) or “agree” (41.4%) that hosting a WTEP intern is a beneficial experience for them, their students, and their schools.

Evidence submitted demonstrates WTEP is specific and intentional about creating authentic partnerships. Besides the Diverse Learner Project with Newport School District, the WTEP collaborates with Imboden Charter School for Eagle Farms STEM Day. The WTEP partners with multiple districts for the Special Olympics Partnership.

Evidence suggests that there is a collaboration between mentors and clinical supervisors. In the K-12 Clinical Educator Handbook one of the responsibilities of the mentor teacher (cooperating teacher) is to share resources frequently and have informal conversations with the WBU supervisor (Clinical Supervisor). The TESS Summative Evaluation, which is a consensus meeting, includes the Intern, cooperating teacher (Mentor), and WBU Internship Supervisor (Clinical supervisor)

In the Partnership focus group, principals and superintendents described regular communication between WBU faculty and supervisors and partner schools. Most participants agreed that the WTEP staff always responds to issues and questions. One participant cited the example of giving feedback about the importance of the PLC process in

addressing learning for all student levels, including gifted and talented students. This feedback was addressed and incorporated.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors
APPROACHING

"The Internship Supervisor Responsibility" document clearly outlines expectations and a timeline to communicate deadlines to clinical supervisors in their roles. A "WTEP Internship Supervisor Role and Resources" Google folder was uploaded with resources such as Handbooks, a calendar, videos of how to conduct the cooperating teacher (Experienced Mentor Teacher) orientation, samples of feedback, and examples of a completed "ISLR Internship Supervisor Responsibilities Chart" that shows week-by-week tasks such as visiting the classroom every two weeks and virtual meetings every two weeks. However, there was no evidence submitted of ongoing coaching support, such as team norming or training to support them in this role. In the 2.2b3 narrative, the EPP shared that "The WTEP has a planned timeline to ensure that all WTEP supervisors have completed coaching training before supervising an intern, as required by recent changes to requirements". Some faculty have started the training, and the rest of the clinical supervisors will attend training this summer. In the Program Director focus group, it was mentioned that the WTEP is moving toward a Cognitive Coaching model in which everyone will be trained – student, clinical supervisor and cooperating (mentor) teacher.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. The evidence submitted includes "GPA Data Fall 2018–Spring 2024," which shows that candidates consistently show proficiency in coursework. The Fall 2023 cohort entered with an average GPA of 3.35, and the average GPA at the end of the semester was 3.49. The Spring 2024 average GPA admission was 3.615. In the Program Director group, participants mentioned that only two students in 12 years didn't meet the criteria of "C or above", and only one candidate in 15 years did not complete their improvement plan.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track, and they take an active role in creating the plan and monitoring progress. Every education major has an assigned academic advisor who meets with the candidate at least once during a two-week window each semester to monitor progress toward degree completion. The advisor monitors candidate proficiency in coursework to ensure candidates maintain the required 2.5 GPA.

The "Graphic of WTEP Student Support System" includes a flow chart of interventions when a candidate is not successful in coursework, including contacting the student, offering support, and scheduling a Student Improvement Conference. The chart links to a sample "Improvement Plan," which the candidate and the clinical supervisor create. The "Student Support System Tracking Document 2020–2024" tracks progress with dates and results of candidates on improvement and success plans.

The Improvement Plan includes a discussion about red flags and areas of concern, an opportunity for the teacher candidate to respond, a place to identify how to get back on track, and agreement to follow this plan. The Program Director's focus group said the WTEB has high expectations but a high level of support. They have continuous faculty collaboration on student progress and expectations, and they track data and individual improvement plans as needed.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internships. Most candidates meet clinical experience goals and milestones. The "Clinical Internship Handbook" outlines the expectations and requirements to complete the internship part of the program successfully. This includes lesson planning, TESS Formal Evaluations, TESS Self-Assessment, and required training and passing the Praxis exam.

The "Tracking Document for Internship Milestones" is a spreadsheet that tracks all candidates and the milestones throughout their internship, such as TESS evaluation, reflection videos, PLT registration, and IDEAS PD hours. Evidence shows that most candidates are progressing and successful. Evidence also includes a "Licensure Checklist Tracking Spreadsheet," a spreadsheet that tracks licensure-related and exit interview milestones, such as Praxis content, Foundations of Reading, and Praxis PLT score data. These documents and spreadsheets all show candidates meeting the clinical experience goals and milestones.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates can impact student growth. The WTEP submitted documents as evidence for this metric. Candidates in "Clinical Internship I (ED 4526) work on an "Impact on Student Learning Research Project" in which they create three learning goals aligned with AR State Standards, pre-assess their learners, teach three to five lessons aligned to their chosen goals, and post-assess their learners.

In the Clinical Experiences focus group, participants discussed several areas in which they saw student growth including students with diverse learning needs who were performing at the level of their peers. Participants also cited their increased knowledge of how to access resources needed for their learning.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive an "effective" score on the TESS Rubric at the end of their clinical internship. The WTEP submitted the "TESS Domain 1-4 Scores Internship" spreadsheet. This spreadsheet shows the ratings for interns in all traditional programs on every component of TESS Domains 1-4. The formative ratings occur at the halfway point of each placement. The summative ratings are completed during the TESS Consensus Meeting, a collaborative effort with the intern, cooperating teacher (mentor teacher), and supervisor (clinical supervisor). This document showed that most candidates receive an "Effective" score on the TESS rubric at the end of their clinical internship, and on average, TESS scores improved from the first placement to the second placement across all content areas. Also, in a survey submitted as evidence, "Departmental Specific Learning Objectives," all respondents felt "prepared" or "well prepared" to teach the content knowledge for their discipline and to manage a classroom effectively.

Note: By 2024-25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

All candidates with varied needs are provided the support needed, including struggling candidates who are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their development in the clinical internship is not on track.

The same "Student Support System" used to help those struggling with coursework is also used to help teaching candidates with support in their clinical experience. A tracking system is maintained to continue following up with students once they have been identified as needing support. The submitted "Spring 2022 Student Improvement Plan" shows evidence of a plan with the candidate and supervisor input during the internship.

High-performing candidates also receive opportunities and feedback that encourage their retention. The WTEP selects two teachers annually to induct into the COE Honors Program. These students have demonstrated excellence in coursework, serious and scholarly interest in the field, intellectual flexibility, active participation, and a strong personal character. Scholars receive a scholarship for Williams Baptist tuition and have opportunities for leadership and travel opportunities. Additional examples of how high-performing candidates were submitted, including the "Spring 24 Nominations for COE Scholars Program at WBU," for which two high-performing candidates in the WTEP were nominated. The "2022-2023 Education Department Award Recipients," which detailed an email notifying the Academic Dean of the selected recipients - one middle-level and one elementary education award winner occurs each year. The "Fall 24 Intern Nomination Letter for Agatha Prator Grant" is a letter of recommendation for the Agatha Prator Grant from Delta Kappa Gamma. High-performing interns are nominated in the fall and spring.

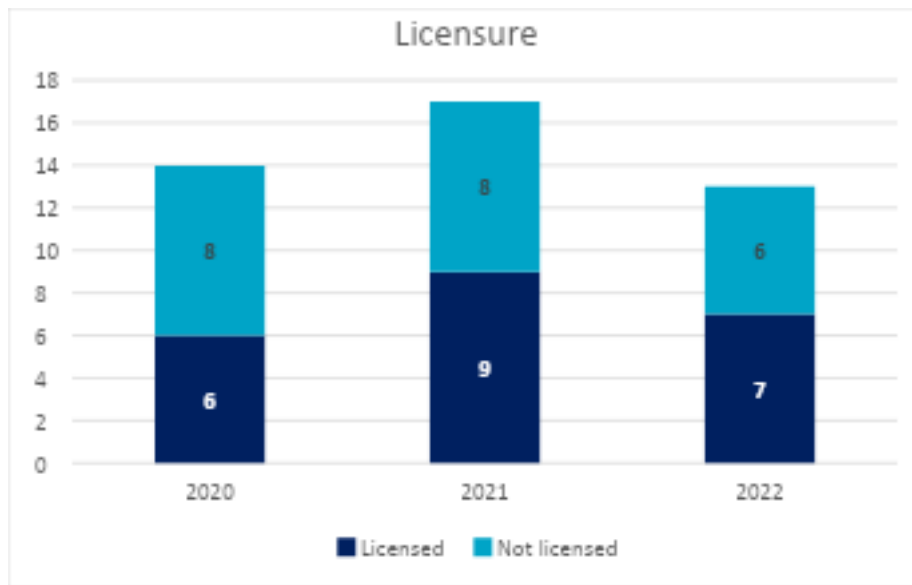


STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
APPROACHING	APPROACHING	APPROACHING
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that Traditional program completers are prepared to obtain standard licensure. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 3.1a)</i> - Although a high proportion of program completers are employed in Arkansas schools, a low proportion of completers are working in high-priority districts and subjects. Pursue initiatives to encourage candidates to consider high-priority subject areas and work placements once licensed. <i>(Focus Area: Criteria 3.2b)</i> - Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify and address any areas of improvement related to effectiveness that could lead to higher value-added scores for WBU completers. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a, 3.3b, and 3.3c)</i>		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who earned a standard license within one year of completion	76%	50%	BELOW

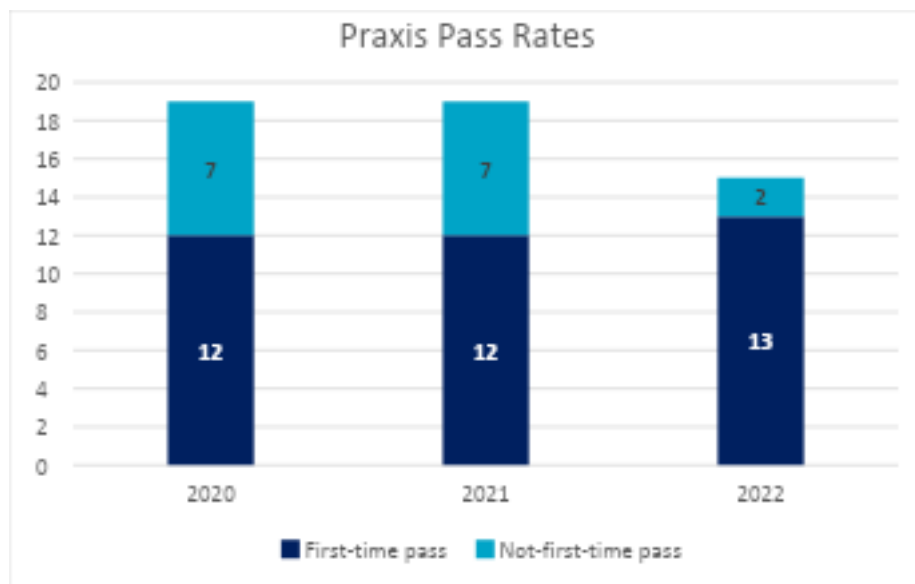


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	n/a	n/a	n/a

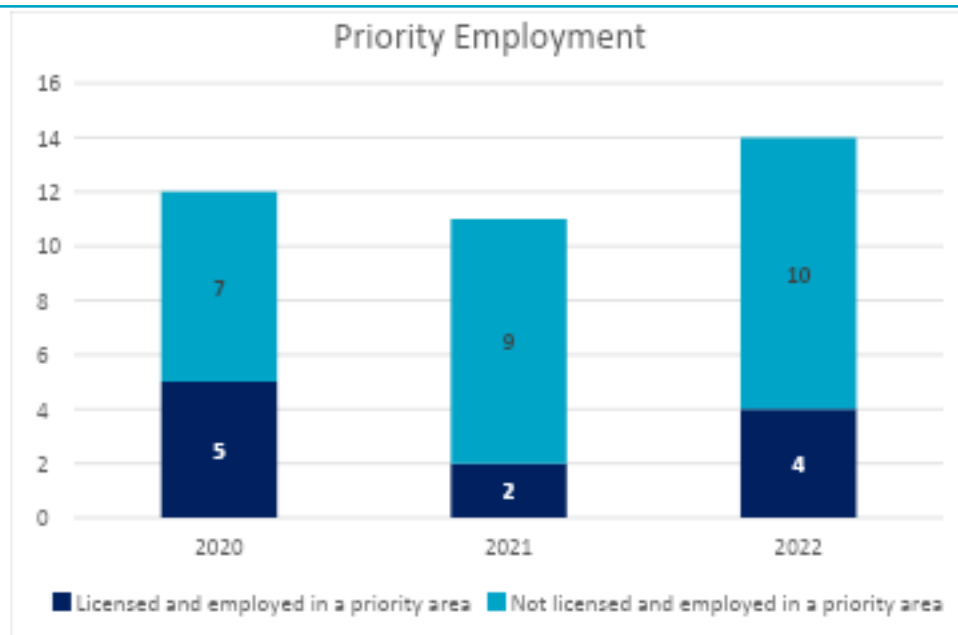
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	69.8%	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas's public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	59.5%	MEETS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and employed</th><th>Not licensed and employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2020</td><td>11</td><td>1</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>5</td><td>6</td></tr><tr><td>2022</td><td>6</td><td>8</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed	2020	11	1	2021	5	6	2022	6	8
Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed													
2020	11	1													
2021	5	6													
2022	6	8													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	29.7%	BELOW												



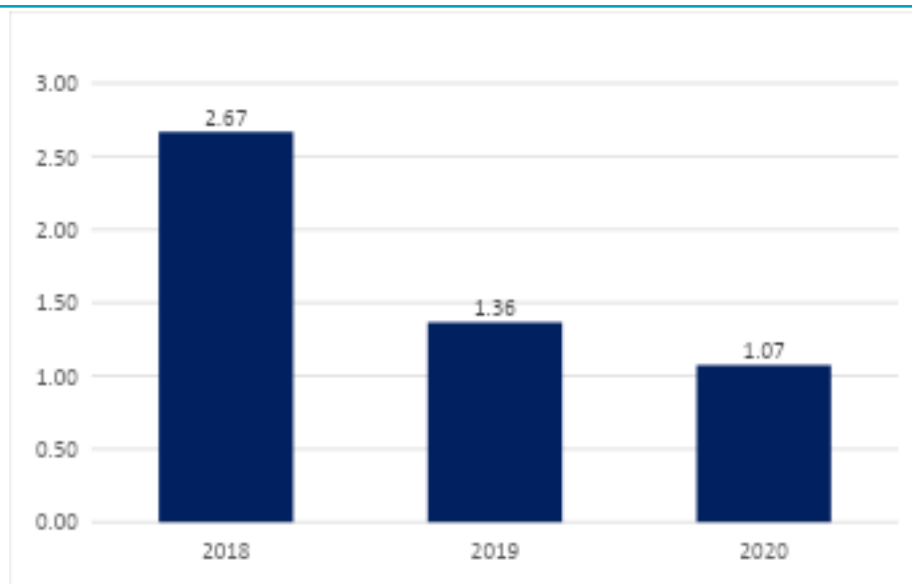
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.68	MEETS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by DESE	81%	100%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by DESE	75%	60%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	36%	APPROACHING

Value-Added Growth Scores

